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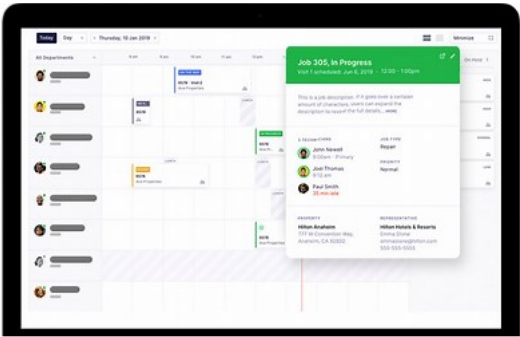
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A bomb cyclone brings blizzards to the Midwest before turning east

Story by LEAH WILLINGHAM and JEFF MARTIN • 1w • 4 min read



 Winter Weather New Hampshire
© Charles Krupa

A strengthening bomb cyclone barreled across the northern U.S. on Monday, unleashing [severe winter weather](#) in the Midwest as it took aim at the East Coast.

 Feedback

The storm brought blizzard conditions, treacherous travel and [power outages](#) to parts of the Plains and Great Lakes on Monday as sharply colder air, strong winds and a mix of snow, ice and rain swept through.



Extreme Weather
© Joel Bissell

Forecasters said the storm intensified quickly enough to meet the criteria of a [bomb cyclone](#), a system that strengthens rapidly as pressure drops. The sharp cold front left parts of the central U.S. waking up Monday to temperatures as much as 50 degrees Fahrenheit (28 degrees Celsius) colder than the day before.



Extreme Weather Michigan
© Andv Morrison

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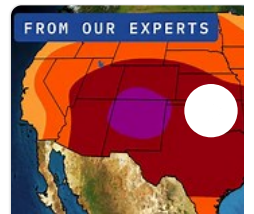
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1 dead in avalanche near Lake Tahoe, California

Story by Matt Lorelli • 8h • 2 min read

The Nevada County Sheriff's Office is confirming that a male snowmobiler died yesterday, [January 5, 2026](#), in an avalanche near Truckee, California. Truckee is 14 miles north of Lake Tahoe.

According to a media release, the initial 911 call was received at 2:19 p.m. Approximately 45 emergency responders were dispatched to the scene from the Nevada County Sheriff's Office, Truckee Fire, and North Truckee Fire. Tahoe Nordic Search and Rescue also responded to the call.

A total of three SnoCats, three snowmobile teams, and multiple skier teams were deployed near Johnson and Castle Peaks, a popular backcountry recreation zone.

"As events unfolded, it was learned (that) the one snowmobiler initially reported missing was found buried under the [snow](#) several minutes later," writes The Nevada County Sheriff's Office. "He was recovered by fellow recreationists, and despite lifesaving efforts, he did not survive."

The Nevada County Sheriff's Office advises backcountry users to avoid the area while they extract the victim.



[L](#) Nevada County Sheriff's Office Incident Command. January 5, 2026. Nevada County Sheriff's Office
© Nevada County Sheriff's Office

Avalanche danger remains high in the area.

A snowboarder was [buried up to his neck](#) in an avalanche on Mt. Judah yesterday as well (image below). Judah is a peak on the other side of Interstate-80 from Castle and Johnson Peaks, where the fatality occurred.

The Sierra Avalanche Center is forecasting 'Moderate' avalanche danger for today, January 6, 2026.

The incident marks the second avalanche-related death in California, and the third in the country, during the Winter 25/26 season. California's first fatality occurred at [Mammoth](#) Mountain on December 26, 2025. Ski patroller [Cole Murphy](#) died in the accident.



└ Mt. Judah avalanche, January 5, 2026, separate from the fatality that occurred on Castle Peak, but a close call nonetheless. "He was only buried up to his head and could breathe but couldn't move his body. We got down and got him out." S
© S

Our thoughts and condolences are with the friends and family of the victim

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▶ **Related video:** Avalanche near Truckee kills one; multiple agencies respond in Nevada County (KXTV-TV Sacramento)

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